



“The open source community offers a great forum to fuel innovations”

Rudramuni B, executive director and head, Dell India R&D Centre

On the occasion of the 10th anniversary of the Dell India R&D Centre, Dhiraj Khare and Jalaja Ramanunni from the *LINUX For You* team caught up with Rudramuni B, executive director and head of the Centre, along with his colleagues—Jagadeesh R, senior manager, OS and Hypervisor Engineering, and Divyanshu Verma, Linux engineering manager. They discussed the scope of Linux, the adoption of open source by Indian businesses, the ISV eco-system, open source projects to which the youth can contribute, and the avenues for building careers around Linux and open source.

Rudramuni started his Linux career with Red Hat Linux 3. Apart from being responsible for the smooth running of operations across Dell's R&D initiatives in India, he is also responsible for multiple operating system technologies for the enterprise market, and out-of-band systems management technologies for enterprise data centres.

Q It has been a decade since the Dell India R&D Centre began operations. Could you tell us about the key milestones it has crossed?

RB: The Dell India R&D Centre started with a small team of just two or three people, to test Dell Enterprise machines. It has been a decade, and now the team has grown to nearly 700 members. All enterprise operating systems are delivered out of Bengaluru.

The organisation now plays a very important role in key decision-making for all operating system offerings in the enterprise market segment.

For instance, the launch of RHEL 7 is eight quarters away from now, but our team has already started working with Red Hat and Fedora teams on the feature list and product road maps of RHEL 7.

Dell India R&D works on several systems management offerings, including Open Manage, Microsoft SCOM-based management solutions, change management and deployment solutions, enterprise cluster solutions, and solutions to manage virtual infrastructure. These solutions are architected, designed, developed and tested out of Bengaluru. All these offerings are very critical to Dell's enterprise business.

The Bengaluru centre delivers all online and offline documentation for Dell's entire product range, including desktops, laptops, netbooks, smartphones, servers, storage, etc.

In short, we have complete ownership over the programs we work on. We take a call on matters like deciding the flavour of the operating system to be supported on Dell enterprise-class hardware; the design